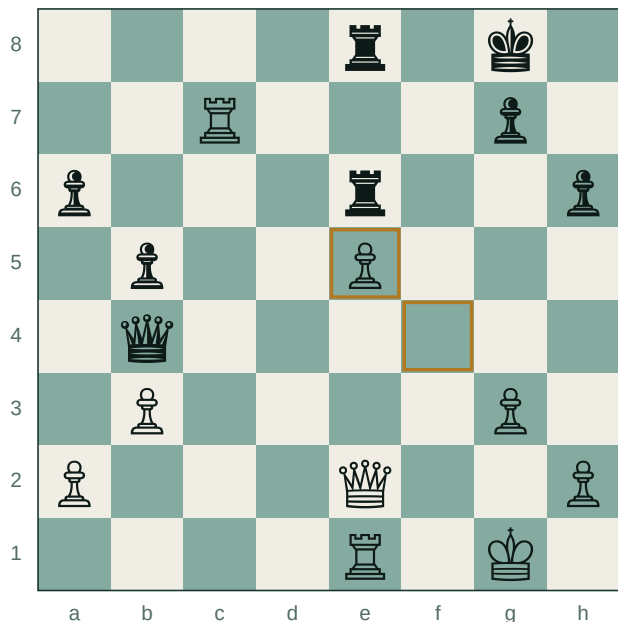


Attraction tactics: Black, move 31

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 31.fxe5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Rxe5 32. Qxe5 Rxe5 33. Rxe5 Qd4+ 34. Kf1 Qxe5

31...Rxe5 The rook captures the pawn on e5. Recorded reply: **32.Qxe5**.

32...Rxe5 The rook captures the queen on e5. Recorded reply: **33.Rxe5**.

33...Qd4+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From d4 it attacks king on g1 and rook on e5. Recorded reply: **34.Kf1**.

34...Qxe5 The queen captures the rook on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on c7. Check for tactical protection.